

PETE CAMBIO, former crack Elmira bowler, will be the challenger of Buffalo's Beat the Champ TV show Saturday afternoon, 5 p.m. . . . Gene Levy suggests a scholastic Class C championship game Odessa - Montour and Mansfield — which isn't too bad an idea. It could be quite a game. . . . Mansfield's Bill Clark wouldn't say so, but beat-Cheyney State has to be one of the all-time glory days for Mansfield State sports. How many times does an underdog end a foe's 67-game win streak? . . . The Star-Gazette Bowling Singles Classic doesn't have the "name" keggers of past seasons, but the league still has the good scores.

Elmira brothers Stu and Jim Stevens are hockey letter winners at Niagara Falls' DeVeaux School. . . . Corning's Don Lando is expected to play his 1967 pro baseball at Kansas City's Woodstock, Ga., farm. . . . Carp Wood, former Elmira Pioneer and present Ithaca College director of athletics, recently returned from the coaches convention in Houston where Andy Cohen was a sub instructor for the baseball clinic. Handy Andy, another well-known former Elmiran, took over the job when death claimed Johnny Keane. . . . It's reported that the Tioga County League's split-season basketball setup isn't going over too well with some league officials. The plan was set up for a playoff to make up the money which the league lost when the annual All-Star game was junked by the state. However, there'll be no playoff if Mansfield wins both halves — which looks more likely every day.

Baseball Group Honors Halas

CHICAGO (AP) — Owner-coach George Halas of the Chicago Bears was honored Thursday night by the Chicago Old Timers Baseball Association, a fitting gesture on Papa Bear's 72nd birthday.

An award to Halas cited his 47 years in pro football, but the National Football League pioneer joked that it was for his brief stint as an outfielder for the New York Yankees in 1919.

"I am getting recognition on the basis of my batting average with the Yankees," smiled the National League pioneer.

"It was either .089 or .092."

Halas spent most of his birthday plotting 1967 strategy with his assistant coaches, about the 20th such meeting since the Bears closed a disappointing 1966 season with 5-7-2.

Retirement is furthestmost from the mind of the man who helped establish the NFL in 1920.

"As I have said frequently, the only thing I'd like to celebrate is a National Football League championship," asserted Halas.

"We have a lot of work to do for 1967. We need every minute of it, birthdays included."

Halas, who recently was pronounced hale and hearty in his annual physical checkup, hopes to bolster the Bears in the NFL's player draft at Honolulu Feb. 20-23.

We need offensive linemen, a deep defensive back, a quarterback and another running back," Halas said. "Perhaps we can fill this need in the draft and by trades."

As the 1966 campaign closed,



George
Halas

regular quarterback Rudy Bukich announced his intended retirement, but Halas feels Bukich may reconsider. At any rate, the Bears need another solid quarterback.

Mostly they need to stiffen an offensive line that last season often left star halfback Gale Sayers feeling mighty lonesome.

Cincy Tops Baltimore

CLEVELAND (AP) — Cincinnati blew a 20-point fourth quarter, but Oscar Robertson, out for about 17 minutes with a pulled hamstring, returned to score the go ahead basket and settled the Royals down for a 131-125 National Basketball Association victory over Baltimore Thursday night.

The Bullets were trailing 104-84 going into the fourth quarter. Kevin Loughery, Don Ohl and Johnny Green closed the gap, with Loughery's jumper giving Baltimore a 115-114 lead with 5:03 left.